# Phase 0: Idea Validation & Research (Month 0–1)

## Goals:

- Validate market need
- Identify competitors and gaps
- Outline basic business model

## Action Items:

1. **Market Research**
    - List direct competitors (Glambot, YouFromMe) and indirect (Ipsy, Poshmark)
    - Identify unsold inventory volumes for brands
    - Research legal restrictions (FDA regulations, OTC drug resale, cosmetics laws)
2. **Target Audience Survey**
    - Conduct surveys/focus groups
    - Ask questions like:
        - Would you buy discounted near-expiration beauty/hygiene products?
        - What price range is acceptable?
        - How important is safety verification?
3. **Initial Idea Validation**
    - Create a landing page / mockup for email signups
    - Collect interest to show investors

---

# Phase 1: Legal & Compliance Setup (Month 1–3)

## Goals:

- Ensure app can operate safely
- Minimize liability
- Create clear seller/buyer rules

## Action Items:

1. **Legal Consultation**
    - Consult a lawyer specializing in:
        - Consumer product law
        - FDA and FTC regulations
        - Liability waivers
2. **Define Product Rules**

    - Only sealed, unused products
    - No prescription drugs
    - Categorize high-risk items (eye/lip products, medicated products)
    - Expiration date requirements
3. **Develop Terms & Conditions**
    - Seller agreement:
        - Authenticity guarantee
        - Expiration and storage confirmation
        - Liability waiver
    - Buyer agreement:
        - Disclaimers on near-expiration
        - Allergy warnings
4. **Check Insurance Needs**
    - Product liability insurance
    - Marketplace coverage
5. **Set Safety Protocols**
    - Verification of batch codes/barcodes
    - Expiration tracking
    - Optional third-party product inspection

---

# Phase 2: Business Model & Financial Planning (Month 2–4)

## Goals:

- Have a clear plan for investors
- Determine pricing, revenue, and logistics

## Action Items:

1. **Business Model**
    - Marketplace commission (e.g., 15–25% per sale)
    - Optional subscription for early access / premium features
    - Partner with brands for surplus inventory
2. **Pricing Strategy**
    - Use tiered discounts based on expiration
    - Near-expiration: 75–90% off retail
    - Mid-life: 50–75%
    - Fresh: 40–60%
3. **Financial Planning**
    - Startup costs: app development, legal fees, insurance, marketing

    - Project 12-month revenue scenarios
4. **Investor Pitch Prep**
    - Deck: problem, solution, market size, differentiation, business model, safety/legality approach
    - Highlight sustainability angle + ESG potential for brands

---

# Phase 3: Product Design & App Planning (Month 3–5)

## Goals:

- Plan core app functionality
- Design UX/UI
- Prepare for developers

## Action Items:

1. **Feature List**
    - Seller onboarding & verification
    - Product listing: photos, expiration dates, category, active ingredients
    - Buyer marketplace: search, filters, safety badges
    - Pricing logic engine (discounts by expiration)
    - Order tracking and delivery
2. **UX/UI Design**
    - Sketch user flows for both buyers and sellers
    - Include safety verification steps prominently
    - Display product expiration & hygiene info clearly
3. **Checklist for Developers**
    - Security features
    - Data storage (user info + product info)
    - Barcode scanning integration
    - Automated compliance checks

---

# Phase 4: MVP Development (Month 5–9)

## Goals:

- Build a minimum viable product (MVP)
- Start testing with limited users

### Action Items:

1. **Select Development Team**
    - Mobile app (iOS/Android)
    - Backend: marketplace, inventory, pricing logic
    - QA for safety-related features
2. **Develop MVP Features**
    - Basic seller onboarding & product listing
    - Buyer marketplace with filters
    - Expiration date logic + warnings
    - Payment integration
3. **Internal Testing**
    - Simulate high-risk products to test rules
    - Verify compliance features
4. **Beta Testing**
    - Invite early users (friends, small focus group)
    - Collect feedback on usability, trust, pricing

---

## Phase 5: Legal & Investor Finalization (Month 8–10)

### Goals:

- Solidify legal foundation
- Secure funding

### Action Items:

1. **Investor Outreach**
    - Present pitch deck + MVP screenshots
    - Emphasize:
        - Sustainable marketplace
        - Safety protocols
        - Differentiation from Ipsy / Glambot
2. **Finalize Terms & Safety Checks**
    - Include disclaimers in-app
    - Confirm insurance coverage
3. **Partnerships**
    - Approach small-to-medium brands for surplus product
    - Offer them sustainability + revenue benefits

---

# Phase 6: Marketing & Pre-Launch (Month 10–12)

## Goals:

- Build user base
- Generate buzz

## Action Items:

1. **Pre-launch Campaign**
    - Landing page with signups
    - Social media campaigns highlighting sustainability + discounts
    - Early-access incentives
2. **Brand Partnerships**
    - Arrange initial inventory supply
    - Secure verified sellers
3. **Trust & Safety Messaging**
    - Safety badges, hygiene protocols, expiration display
    - Highlight third-party verification if used

---

# Phase 7: Launch (Month 12–13)

## Goals:

- Launch MVP to public
- Monitor user adoption & safety

## Action Items:

1. **Soft Launch**
    - Limited geographic area or product categories
    - Monitor compliance & user feedback
2. **Full Launch**
    - Expand to more regions / products
    - Start larger marketing campaigns
3. **Performance Metrics**
    - User adoption
    - Sales volume
    - Returns / complaints (esp. safety-related)

---

## Phase 8: Growth & Scaling (Month 14–18)

### Goals:

- Expand marketplace
- Optimize pricing & safety
- Attract additional investors / partners

### Action Items:

1. **App Optimization**
    - Add advanced filters (by brand, ingredient, risk)
    - Refine pricing engine
2. **User Retention**
    - Loyalty programs
    - Push notifications for expiring deals
3. **New Partnerships**
    - Larger brands
    - Logistic partners for returns / deliveries
4. **Investor Update / Series A Prep**
    - Show growth metrics
    - Highlight sustainability + revenue impact

# ✅ Summary of Checklists & Rules to Implement

### Seller Checklist:

- Product sealed and unused
- Expiration date provided
- Complies with legal rules (no prescription drugs)
- Safety category assigned
- Storage conditions confirmed

### Buyer Checklist:

- Expiration date visible
- Safety badges shown
- Allergy warnings provided
- Terms & conditions acknowledged

## Legal / Safety Rules:

- FDA compliance for OTC products
- Liability disclaimers
- Product authenticity guarantee
- Insurance coverage for marketplace liability

## App Features Checklist:

- Barcode scanning
- Pricing engine based on expiration
- Verification system
- Reviews / ratings for sellers
- Secure payments

# WHY WE WIN: COMPETITOR LANDSCAPE

| COMPETITOR | WEAKNESS | OUR ADVANTAGE |
|---|---|---|
| **IPSY**<br>SUBSCRIPTION | Overconsumption & Waste | **INTENTIONAL USAGE** |
| **POSHMARK / GLAMBOT**<br>RESALE MARKETPLACE | No Safety Standards | **VERIFIED & SEALED** |
| **YOUFROMME**<br>PEER-TO-PEER | Hygiene & Trust Barriers | **INFRASTRUCTURE TRUST** |
| **ROSS / BURLINGTON**<br>OFF-PRICE RETAIL | Expired Inventory Risk | **VERIFIED FRESHNESS** |
| **THE INDUSTRY**<br>MARKET STANDARD | "Buy More" Mentality | **"BUY BETTER" STANDARD** |

# REDEFINING THE STANDARD

| FEATURE | EXISTING PLATFORMS | OUR MARKETPLACE |
|---|---|---|
| PRIMARY GOAL | Selling More | **BUYING BETTER** |
| INVENTORY | Open Marketplace | **VERIFIED & SEALED** |
| INCENTIVE | Discovery & Trends | **USAGE & COMPLETION** |
| SUSTAINABILITY | Waste is a Byproduct | **WASTE IS ELIMINATED** |
| SAFETY | User-to-User Trust | **INFRASTRUCTURE TRUST** |